

The dialogue ended, the prophet's tone changes ; and 63, 7—64, 12, in the assurance that the redemption guaranteed by Jehovah's triumph will be wrought out, he supplies faithful Israel with a hymn of thanksgiving, supplication, and confession, expressive of the frame of mind worthy to receive it, and couched in a strain of surpassing pathos and beauty. C. 65 appears to be intended as an answer to the supplication of c. 64,—an answer, however, in which the distinction, alluded to above, is drawn between the worthy and unworthy Israelites. God has ever, He says, been accessible to His people, and ready to renew intercourse with them ; it was they who would not respond, but provoked Him with their idolatries. Israel, however, is not to be rejected on account of the presence within it of unworthy members : a seed of "chosen ones" will be brought out of Jacob, who shall again inherit the mountains of Palestine. A new order of things (*vi.* 17 ; cf. 51, 16) is about to be created, in which Jerusalem and her people will be to Jehovah a source of unalloyed delight, and in which care and disappointment will cease to vex. 66, 1—5 the prophet, in view probably of the anticipated restoration of the Temple, reminds the Jews that no earthly habitation is really adequate to Jehovah's majesty, and that His regard is to be won, neither by the magnificence of a material temple, nor by unspiritual service, but by humility and the devotion of the heart. He concludes, *vv.* 6—24, by two contrasted pictures of the glorious blessedness in store for Jerusalem, and the terrible judgment impending over her foes.

*Authorship of c. 40—66.* Three independent lines of argument converge to show that this prophecy is not the work of Isaiah, but, like 13, 2—14, 23, has for its author a prophet writing towards the close of the Babylonian captivity. (1) The *internal evidence* supplied by the prophecy itself points to this period as that at which it was written. It alludes repeatedly to Jerusalem as ruined and deserted (*e.g.* 44, 26<sup>b</sup>. 58, 12. 61, 4. 63, 18. 64, 10 f.) ; to the sufferings which the Jews have experienced, or are experiencing, at the hands of the Chaldeans (42, 22. 25. 43, 28 [*R.V. marg.*]. 47, 6. 52, 5) ; to the prospect of return, which, as the prophet speaks, is imminent (40, 2. 46, 13. 48, 20 &c.). Those whom the prophet addresses, and, moreover, addresses *in person*—arguing with them, appealing to them, striving to win their assent by his warm and impassioned rhetoric (40, 21. 26. 28. 43,